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THREAT PERCEPTIONS IN THE MYANMAR–BANGLADESH BORDERLANDS

Helal Mohammed Khan

Many complexities that symbolize Myanmar today stem from its borders, border people, and border regions. From Karen and Shan in the east to Kachin and Wa in the north, to Chin and Rakhine in the west, Myanmar's periphery commotions affect its stability and its peace conditions (ICG 2015). Researchers have studied these phenomena, and their approaches range from queries on Myanmar's borders (for example, Cohen 2013; Morshed 2012; Schendel and de Maaker 2014) to nuanced studies on border people, policies, and regions (notably, Chen 2014; Farrelly 2012; Pate 2010).

The way peripheries have dominated Myanmar's future brings to the fore some old questions: what are the causes of conflicts at these outer regions? How do they relate to border administration, and how do the security echelons operating on either side of the border perceive threats? Do these assessments come from physical, tangible elements of fear? Or do they draw from intangible and often imperceptible fear factors like religion, ethnicity, cultures, and languages of the bordering people?